INCH-POUND

A-A-20152B
October 15, 2001
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20152A
April 4, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CABBAGE, READY-TO-USE, SHREDDED, FRESH

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE. This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. PURCHASER NOTES.

2.1 Purchasers *shall specify* the following:

- Variety(ies) and shred thickness(es) required (Sec. 3).
- Manufacturer's/distributor's certification (Sec. 8.2) or USDA certification (Sec. 8.3).

2.2 Purchasers *may specify* the following:

- Manufacturer's quality assurance (Sec. 8.1 with 8.1.1), (Sec. 8.1 with 8.1.2), or (Sec. 8.1 with 8.1.3).
- Packaging requirements other than commercial (Sec. 9).

3. CLASSIFICATION. The fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage shall conform to the following list as specified in the solicitation, contact, or purchase order.

Varieties and shred thicknesses.

Variety I - Green
Variety II - Red

Shred thickness 1 - 1/16 inch (0.159 cm)
Shred thickness 2 - 1/8 inch (0.318 cm)

FSC 8915

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Shred thickness 3 - 3/16 inch (0.476 cm)
Shred thickness 4 - 1/4 inch (0.635 cm)
Shred thickness 5 - Other

4. MANUFACTURER'S/DISTRIBUTOR'S NOTES. Manufacturer's/distributor's products *shall meet* the requirements of the:

- Salient characteristics (Sec. 5).
- Manufacturer's/distributor's product assurance (Sec. 6).
- Regulatory requirements (Sec. 7).
- Quality assurance provisions: *as specified by the purchaser* (Sec. 8).

5. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

5.1 Processing. The fresh shredded cabbage shall be processed in accordance with good manufacturing practice (21 CFR Part 110).

5.2 Cabbage. The cabbage shall be firm, compact and clean; sound without decay, off-odors, off-colors; and of the green or red varieties as specified.

5.3 Preparation. The cabbage heads shall be properly trimmed to remove outer leaves and discolored, damaged, or diseased portions. The core shall be removed. The cabbage shall be uniformly cut (sliced) to yield shreds of the thickness specified.

5.4 Food additives. The shredded cabbage may be treated with antioxidants which are listed in the Food and Drug Administration's (FDA) Generally Recognized as Safe (GRAS) list. However, shredded cabbage intended for use in the fresh state shall not be treated with sulfur dioxide or other sulfating agents as prohibited under provisions of the Federal, Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5.5 Finished product.

5.5.1 Shred thickness. The cabbage shreds shall be uniform in thickness and the appearance shall not be more than slightly affected by the presence of short or irregular cut pieces.

5.5.2 Texture and flavor. The cabbage shreds shall be fresh and crisp and not flabby or tough. The cabbage shreds shall not be bitter in flavor.

5.5.3 Color and odor. The green cabbage shreds shall be whitish green to green in color. The red cabbage shreds shall be white, whitish red, reddish purple to purple in color. The cabbage shreds shall have a fresh, characteristic odor. The cabbage shreds shall be free of off-odors such as, but not limited to; chlorine, ammonia, musty/moldy, sour, and fermented smells.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

5.5.4 Temperature. The fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage shall be kept under refrigeration to maintain quality. Unless otherwise recommended, temperatures greater than 32°F (0°C) but not more than 38°F (3.3°C) are recommended.

5.5.5 Defects. The fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage shall be practically free of large pieces, core pieces, and discolored shreds or pieces including tipburn. Major defects are soft rot and discolored shreds or pieces including tipburn. The areas of discolored pieces should not exceed ¼ square inch (½ x ½ in.) (1.61 square cm [1.27 cm x 1.27 cm]) per 12 ounces (340 g) net weight of product. Minor defects are large pieces of leaves and large pieces of core material. Major defects may be present that do not more than slightly affect the appearance or eating quality of the product. Minor defects may be present that do not materially affect the appearance or eating quality of the product.

5.5.6 Foreign material. Presence of foreign material or adhering dirt, sand, or soil on the cabbage shreds shall be cause for rejection.

6. MANUFACTURER'S/DISTRIBUTOR'S PRODUCT ASSURANCE. The manufacturer/ distributor shall certify that the fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the their own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same fresh, shredded ready-to-use cabbage offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of conformance.

7. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The delivered fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage within the commercial marketplace. Delivered fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

8. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. *Purchaser shall specify 8.2 or 8.3; purchaser may specify 8.1 with 8.1.1, 8.1 with 8.1.2, or 8.1 with 8.1.3.*

8.1 Manufacturer's quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the product manufacturer shall be required to provide evidence, by certificate, that the manufacturing plant has undertaken one of the following quality assurance measures within 12 months prior to providing a bid, or no later than 10 business days from the date of awarding of the contract. Failure to provide this documentation within the proper time frame may result in the contract being terminated for cause.

8.1.1 Plant systems audit. A plant systems audit (PSA) conducted by USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), or another audit performed by a third party auditing service is

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

required within 12 months prior to the date of the awarding of the contract. *(An AMS PSA verifies the manufacturer's capability to produce products in a clean, sanitary environment in accordance with Title 21 Code of Federal Regulations Part 110 - Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Packing, or Holding Human Food, and verifies that the manufacturer has in place an internal quality assurance program. The AMS PSA determines the manufacturer's ability to produce under this CID, if the products of interest are identified at the time of the PSA.)*

8.1.2 Plant survey. A plant survey conducted by USDA, AMS, or another survey performed by a third party auditing service is required within 12 months prior to the date of the awarding of the contract. *(An AMS plant survey audit verifies that, at the time of the survey, the manufacturer produces products in a clean, sanitary environment in accordance with Title 21 Code of Federal Regulations Part 110 - Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Packing, or Holding Human Food.)*

8.1.3 Qualified Through Verification (QTV) Audit. Acceptance by a facility into the USDA, AMS QTV Program within 12 months prior to the date of awarding the contract is required. *(An AMS QTV audit verifies, at the time of the audit, the manufacturer produces products in a clean, sanitary environment in accordance with Title 21 Code of Federal Regulations Part 110 – Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Packing, or Holding of Human Food.)*

8.2 Manufacturer's/distributor's certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the manufacturer/distributor will certify that the finished fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage distributed meets or exceeds the requirements of this CID.

8.3 USDA certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality and acceptability or both be determined, the Fresh Products Branch (FPB), Fruit and Vegetable Programs (FVP), AMS, USDA, shall be the certifying program. FPB inspectors shall certify the quality and acceptability of the fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage in accordance with FPB procedures which include selecting random samples of the packaged fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage, evaluating the samples for conformance with the salient characteristics of this CID and other contractual requirements, and documenting the findings on official FPB score sheets and/or certificates. In addition, when required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, FPB inspectors will examine the fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage for conformance to the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

9. PACKAGING. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be commercial unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

10. USDA INSPECTION NOTES. When Section 8.3 is specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, USDA certification shall include evaluation of the quality and

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

condition of samples of packaged fresh shredded ready-to-use cabbage, and compliance with requirements in the following areas:

- Salient characteristics (Sec. 5).
- Packaging requirements (Sec. 9 or as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order).

11. REFERENCE NOTES.

11.1 USDA contacts.

11.1.1 USDA certification contact. For USDA certification, contact the **Branch Chief, FPB, FVP, AMS, USDA, STOP 0240, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0240 telephone, (202) 720-5870, Fax (202) 720-0393, or via E-mail: larry.lace@usda.gov.**

11.1.2 USDA QTV contact. For a USDA QTV audit, contact the **Branch Chief, Processed Products Branch, FVP, AMS, USDA, STOP 0247, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0247, telephone (202) 720-4693, Fax (202) 690-1527, or via E-mail: james.rodeheaver@usda.gov.**

11.2 Sources of documents.

11.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954. Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents (202) 512-1800 or on the Internet at: http://www.nara.gov/fedreg.**

Copies of this CID and the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, and beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this CID are available from and/or provided to: **Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, FVP, AMS, USDA, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243, telephone (202) 720-9939, Fax (202) 690-0102, via E-mail: FQAStaff@usda.gov or on the Internet at: http://www.ams.usda.gov/fv/fvqual.htm.**

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Document Automation And Production Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, HIS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) prohibits discrimination in all its programs and activities on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, religion, age, disability, political beliefs, sexual orientation, or marital or family status. (Not all prohibited bases apply to all programs.) Persons with disabilities who require alternative means for communication of program information (Braille, large print, audiotape, etc.) should contact USDA's TARGET Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and TDD).

To file a complaint of discrimination, write USDA, Director, Office of Civil Rights, Room 326-W, Whitten Building, 14th and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-9410 or call (202) 720-5964 (voice and TDD). USDA is an equal opportunity provider and employer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.